

Akira Kawabata

Ph.D. student

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Research Interests

Scalable oversight, alignment

Work Experience

Research Engineer, The Asahi Shimbun Company Apr. 2023 – Mar. 2026

Education

Ph.D. student, Department of Informatics, SOKENDAI / National Institute of Informatics (NII) (Supervisor: Saku Sugawara) Apr. 2026 – Present

M.Eng., Nara Institute of Science and Technology (Supervisor: Taro Watanabe) Apr. 2021 – Mar. 2023

B.A., Hitotsubashi University Apr. 2016 – Mar. 2021

Publications

- **C2: Scalable Rubric-Augmented Reward Modeling from Binary Preferences.** Akira Kawabata, Saku Sugawara. In Proceedings of the 64th Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2026. (To appear) [Paper](#) | [Code](#)
- **Rationale-Aware Answer Verification by Pairwise Self-Evaluation.** Akira Kawabata, Saku Sugawara. In Proceedings of the 2024 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2024. [Paper](#) | [Code](#)
- **Evaluating the Rationale Understanding of Critical Reasoning in Logical Reading Comprehension.** Akira Kawabata, Saku Sugawara. In Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing (EMNLP), 2023. [Paper](#) | [Code](#)

Awards & Scholarships

- Young Researcher's Encouragement Award, the 29th Annual Meeting of the Association of Natural Language Processing, 2023.
- International News Media Association (INMA) 30 Under 30 Awards, 2025.
- SOKENDAI Special Researcher Program (supported by JST BOOST), Apr. 2026–Present.